

YOUR GAME · SUN, SEP 6 · 1930 ET · NBC

Wisconsin (8%) at #4 Notre Dame (92%) Notre Dame -20.5

Win and Notre Dame's playoff odds are 76.6%; lose and they're 63.1%. A 13.5-point swing, the biggest thing on this page by far.

Ranked by leverage · how much the result moves Notre Dame's playoff odds, discounted by how unlikely the swing is · the boxed team is the one to pull for

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Mon, Sep 7 · 1930 ET · ESPN

#19 SMU (52%)

 at **Florida State** (48%) SMU -3 · O/U 53.5

A SMU win happens 52% of the time and is worth 0.32 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.7% vs 74.4%)
Mostly because SMU is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 12); the better their record, the more your result against them counts (proj. 8 wins); also Florida State is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 5% of seasons).

Leverage 58 Impact 52
- 2

Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · ABC

Clemson (28%)

 at **#11 LSU** (72%) LSU -10 · O/U 50.5

A Clemson win happens 28% of the time and is worth 0.16 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.7% vs 74.6%)
Because LSU is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).

Leverage 24 Impact 26
- 3

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ABC

Baylor (32%)

 at **Auburn** (68%) Auburn -7.5 · O/U 59.5

A Baylor win happens 32% of the time and is worth 0.12 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.7% vs 74.5%)
Because Auburn is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 6% of seasons).

Leverage 18 Impact 19
- 4

Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · FOX

Fresno State (10%)

 at **#14 USC** (90%) USC -22.5 · O/U 51.5

A Fresno St win happens 10% of the time and is worth 0.28 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.6%)
Because USC is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 14% of seasons).

Leverage 18 Impact 45
- 5

Sun, Sep 6 · 1600 ET · NBC

Washington State (9%)

 at **#17 Washington** (91%) Washington -23.5 · O/U 51.5

A Wash St win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.29 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.6%)
Because Washington is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 17 Impact 46
- 6

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · CBS

Boise State (6%)

 at **#2 Oregon** (94%) Oregon -24.5 · O/U 51.5

A Boise St win happens 6% of the time and is worth 0.38 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.5%)
Because Oregon is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 29% of seasons).

Leverage 14 Impact 62
- 7

Sat, Sep 5 · 1200 ET · ABC

East Carolina (9%)

 at **#13 Alabama** (91%) Alabama -28.5 · O/U 52.5

A ECU win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.21 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.6%)
Because Alabama is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 12 Impact 34
- 8

Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · ESPN

#7 Miami (91%)

 at **Stanford** (9%) Miami -24.5 · O/U 48.5

A Miami win happens 91% of the time and is worth 0.21 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.6% vs 74.4%)
Mostly because Miami is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 10); the better their record, the more your result against them counts (proj. 10 wins); also this affects who wins the ACC, and a champion takes an auto-bid instead of an at-large spot.

Leverage 12 Impact 34
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Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ESPN

Texas State (5%)

 at **#5 Texas** (95%) Texas -29.5 · O/U 59.5

A Texas St win happens 5% of the time and is worth 0.34 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.5%)
Because Texas is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).

Leverage 12 Impact 55
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Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · NBC

Western Michigan (6%)

 at **#16 Michigan** (94%) Michigan -27.5 · O/U 49.5

A W Michigan win happens 6% of the time and is worth 0.26 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.5%)
Because Michigan is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 11 Impact 43

Leverage and impact are scaled 0–100 against the biggest remaining game that doesn't involve Notre Dame. Win chances from SP+ with home advantage; every number from 30,000 simulated seasons with each game flipped one at a time.